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Comment On: NSF_FRDOC_0001-3479

Request for Information: Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

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Comment on FR Doc # 2025-02305

Submitter Information

Email: [REDACTED]

Organization: FUTURESIGHT LLC

General Comment

March 14, 2025

From:

Caiden Truss

Business Owner

Pasadena California

Subject: National Science Foundation's Request for Information on Developing an Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan

As a small business owner and visual artist, I've dedicated my career to creating original work that not only supports myself but also contributes to the cultural and creative fabric of our country. However, the rapid rise of artificial intelligence, particularly systems developed by tech giants like OpenAI and Google, has introduced a profound challenge to creators like me. These companies are leveraging our work—often without permission or compensation—to build AI tools that directly compete with us, all while pushing for changes to copyright law that would further erode our rights.

The issue at hand is not just about technology; it's about fairness, ownership, and the future of creativity in America. AI systems are trained on vast datasets that include the work of countless artists, writers, musicians, and designers. My designs, along with the creations of so many others, have been fed into these systems without our knowledge, let alone our consent. These companies then use our work to produce outputs that mimic our styles, undercut our businesses, and ultimately devalue the very skills we've spent years developing.

Now, these same companies are advocating for legal changes that would allow them to continue this practice under the umbrella of "fair use." They argue that if an AI system processes copyrighted material, it should be exempt from the same protections that apply to human creators. This reasoning is not only flawed but dangerous. It suggests that anything shared online—regardless of who created it—is fair game for corporate exploitation. They claim this is necessary for innovation, but in reality, it undermines the very foundation of creativity. The purpose of copyright law is to protect creators and incentivize innovation.

If we allow tech companies to freely use and profit from our work without permission or compensation, we risk dismantling the ecosystem that fosters creativity. Why would anyone invest time, energy, and resources into creating something new if they know it can be instantly copied, repurposed, and sold by a machine? How can small businesses like mine survive in a world where our work is commodified by corporations with far greater resources and reach?

To truly support innovation, this administration must prioritize the rights of creators.

The AI Action Plan should not be a handout to Big Tech; it should be a framework that ensures a fair and equitable playing field for all. Here are three principles that should guide this effort:

Respect for Ownership: Creators must retain control over their work. Any use of copyrighted material by AI systems should require explicit permission from the original creator. This ensures that individuals, not corporations, decide how their work is used.

Fair Compensation: The AI Action Plan should promote a licensing system that allows creators to be fairly compensated for the use of their work. This would create a sustainable model where both innovation and creativity can thrive, without sacrificing the rights of individuals.

Transparency and Accountability: Companies developing AI systems should be required to disclose the sources of their training data and clearly label AI-generated content. This transparency is essential for maintaining trust and ensuring that creators are aware of how their work is being used.

I believe in the potential of AI to transform industries and improve lives, but not at the expense of creators like myself. We cannot allow the hard work and creativity of everyday Americans to be exploited for the benefit of a few powerful corporations. The AI Action Plan must strike a balance that fosters innovation while protecting the rights and livelihoods of those who make creativity possible.

Thank you for considering my perspective. I urge you to prioritize the rights of creators and ensure that the future of AI is one that benefits everyone, not just the tech giants.

Sincerely,
Caiden Truss

Attachments

Letter to AI

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